

HOUSE No. 4215

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

PRESENTED BY:

Donald H. Wong

To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act regarding the disability pension of Christopher Taylor.

PETITION OF:

NAME:	DISTRICT/ADDRESS:	DATE ADDED:
<i>Donald H. Wong</i>	<i>9th Essex</i>	<i>6/3/2025</i>
<i>Jessica Ann Giannino</i>	<i>16th Suffolk</i>	<i>6/10/2025</i>
<i>Brendan P. Crighton</i>	<i>Third Essex</i>	<i>6/12/2025</i>

HOUSE No. 4215

By Representative Wong of Saugus, a petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 4215) of Donald H. Wong (by vote of the town) that the Saugus retirement board be authorized to increase the accidental disability retirement allowance payable to Christopher Taylor, a retired officer of the police department of the town of Saugus. Public Service. [Local Approval Received.]

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act regarding the disability pension of Christopher Taylor.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 SECTION 1. (a) Notwithstanding any general or special law to the contrary, the Saugus
2 retirement board shall increase the accidental disability retirement allowance payable to
3 Christopher Taylor, a retired officer of the police department of the Tow of Saugus who, as a
4 result of injuries sustained while in the performance of his duties on August 6, 2020, is totally
5 and permanently incapacitated from performing the essential duties of a police officer.

6 (b) The annual amount of pension payable to Christopher Taylor shall be equal to the
7 regular rate of compensation which would have been paid had he continued in service as a police
8 officer of the Town of Saugus at the grade held by him at the time of his retirement until his
9 death or reaching mandatory retirement age, whichever comes first. All amounts paid under this
10 act shall be non-taxable to the extent allowable under state and federal law.

11 (c) the additional benefits granted herein shall be funded and administered by the Saugus
12 Retirement Board, consistent with and subject to chapter 32 of the General Laws, except that
13 sections 8 and 91A of Chapter 32 of the General Laws shall not apply however all amounts paid
14 hereunder shall be non-taxable.

15 (d) Upon attaining the mandatory retirement age for a police officer of the Town of
16 Saugus, Christopher Taylor shall receive a pension pursuant to section 7 of said chapter 32, a
17 yearly amount of pension equal to 80 per cent of the annual rate of the compensation he was
18 receiving on the day before he reaches the mandatory retirement age for a police officer in the
19 Town of Saugus.

20 (e) Notwithstanding any general or special law to the contrary the benefits granted herein
21 shall be funded and administered by the Saugus retirement board, consistent with and subject to
22 chapter 32 of the General Laws.

23 SECTION 2. Notwithstanding any general or special law to the contrary, Christopher
24 Taylor shall be entitled to receive indemnification for all hospital, medical and related expenses
25 that have been or may be incurred after the date of his retirement as a result of the injuries
26 sustained by him while in the performance of his duties on August 7, 2013, in accordance with
27 sections 100 and 1008 of chapter 41 of the General Laws.

28 SECTION 3. Notwithstanding any general or special law to the contrary, the Saugus
29 retirement board shall forthwith pay to said Christopher Taylor the amount credited to him as
30 accumulated total deductions in the annuity savings fund of the Saugus retirement board as of the
31 effective date of this act.

SECTION 4. Notwithstanding any general or special law to the contrary, if Christopher Taylor was married to upon retirement, upon his death, if he is still married to the spouse he was married to upon retirement then, should his spouse to whom he married on the date upon retirement survive him, the retirement board of the Town of Saugus shall pay to the spouse an annuity in the amount of 75 per cent of the amount of the pension which otherwise would have been payable to Christopher Taylor until the spouse's death. The pension benefits provided for in this section and section 1 shall be subject to section 103 of chapter 32 of the General Laws.

SECTION 5. In the event that both Christopher Taylor and his spouse to whom he was married on the date upon retirement die before their children reach the age of 18 the payments that would otherwise have been made to Christopher Taylor's spouse shall be payable, per stirpes, to each surviving children under the age of 18, provided, however, that payments shall continue for the benefit of a surviving child 18 years or older who, on or before the date of death of Christopher Taylor or his spouse to whom he was married on the date upon retirement, whichever is later, had been medically determined to be permanently physically or mentally incapacitated from earning or the benefit of a child under the age of 22 who is enrolled as a full-time student as determined by the criteria of the educational institution.